

GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Flask Basics

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What is Flask?

Flask is a *lightweight* **web framework** for python.

- **Web Framework**: software development pattern that supports the development of web applications, web services, web APIs, and so on. If you want to build a full scale web app or a production API in python, it can be done in Flask.
- *Lightweight*: Flask does not enforce any outside dependencies. Some web frameworks make you use a specific database connector, template engine, etc. Flask gives us complete control over how we build.

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Why learn Flask?

- **Flask has low development overhead**: we don't have to install dependencies or write additional code in order to get started.
- **Flask is incredibly flexible**: it allows us to build a variety of things. Some examples that we will building today:
    - Static Web Pages
    - JSON data responses (like reddit)
    - Web Forms to collect info from users

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Review: Web APIs

The most common type of API that we interact with is a Web API. These power websites or allow access to data in a database, typically handled using HTTP.

Our typical web api usage up to this point:

We make some request:	The API responds to our request:	We do something with the response:
GET www.reddit.com	return some_html	BeautifulSoup(res.content)

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How do we know when/how to respond?

Users make requests to a specific URL which can be broken down into two parts: the **base URL** and the **route**.

e.g. https://www.reddit.com/r/BirdsArentReal.json



Base URL: https://www.reddit.com
Route: /r/BirdsArentReal.json

Our job as API developers is to build out each of the routes that we want our users to be able to access.

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Quick Detour: Pickling

- As a part of today's codealong, we will be using a pre-trained model to serve predictions to our user. The pre-trained model is saved to a file in the repo, **model.p**.
- In python, the process of saving/opening an object to/from a file is called **Pickling.** The object is not changed in any way by this process.
- For more on this process or to see the exact code, please refer to the **pickle_flow.ipynb** in this repo. Your local instructor will also be a great resource for additional info.

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